Aborts

An **abort** is the Slocum's self-preservation reflex: when something goes wrong, the glider stops flying its mission, makes itself positively buoyant, turns on everything that can be used to locate it, and comes to the surface so a pilot can take over. Understanding *why* a glider aborted — and how patient it will be before it does something irreversible like dropping its weight — is one of the core skills of piloting a Slocum.

This page is a field reference for reading and responding to aborts. It is **not** a substitute for getting your hands on the actual abort/ `.mlg` log and, for a glider at sea, contacting **glidersupport@teledyne.com** — TWR explicitly asks that operational aborts be handled through support, not the user forum.

> **Source**
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> Paraphrased from the Webb Research *abort sequences* engineering write-up (`doco/abort-sequuences.txt` / *Slocum abort behaviours*), the *Slocum G3 Glider Operators Manual*, the `masterdata` `abend` behavior block, the Teledyne Webb Research user forum (the **Aborts** board in particular), and the UG2 community Slack. Behavior arguments, sensor names, and defaults move between firmware releases — **always confirm against the `masterdata` and `command.h` shipped with your firmware**, and simulate mission changes in the lab before flying them.

The three kinds of abort

There are three abort mechanisms, in increasing order of "the software is in trouble":